

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

2000-132

Rec'd 2/19/01 wpl

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) Bay-breasted Warbler

(Scientific Name) *Dendroica castanea*

Date(s) of occurrence: 24 May 2000

Number of birds seen: 1 adult female

Location: SW corner of Crow Valley Campground, SW of junipers, Pawnee National Grasslands, Weld Co., CO

Length of observation: 15 minutes

Time(s) of observation: 9:30 (roughly)

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Joe Fontaine and others

Conditions: warm and sunny.

Optical equipment used: B & L Elite 10 x 42 binocular.

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 8 - 35 meters

Photos: no

Habitat: Riparian

Details: Joe Fontaine had a brief look at an unusual warbler and called my attention to it. We found it a couple seconds later and realized it was an adult female Bay-breasted Warbler. It was similar in size and shape to a Yellow-rumped Warbler, but appeared heavier bodied and much shorter tailed (i.e. its shape was like a Blackpoll Warbler). The tail was about 1/2 the length of the undertail coverts. Forehead olive gray with dark streaks contrasting markedly with rich chestnut cap. Face mottled dark with prominent buff-cream eye-arcs and supraloral stripe. Buff patch on sides of neck. Throat and upper breast mottled cinnamon, continuing down sides of breast and flanks. Otherwise underparts buffy, more white in center of belly. Mantle olivish in color with black streaking. Wings dark with prominent white wings bars. Some greenish edging to primaries and secondaries. Tail dark with white spots seen in outermost (outermost two?) rectrices in flight.

Only difficulty is in aging / sexing. The buff eye-arcs on a dark face, and more extensive bay, and unworn wings and head pattern indicate an adult female. (See Dunn and Garrett.)

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have seen hundreds of Bay-breasted Warblers while living in Wisconsin, Indiana and Cape May, NJ. I have also seen hundreds of all similar species. This is my first Bay-breasted Warbler for Colorado!

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): Age and sex info from Dunn and Garrett's *Warblers* (1997).

This report is from notes made immediately after observation.

Date of written report: 10 February 2001

Reporting observer: Christopher L. Wood, zeledonia@att.net

Signature: *Christopher L. Wood (electronic submission)*

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